

Newborough Warren Weather & Water Watch

July 2026

Weather Summary

Metric	Local gauge (IBODOR6)	RAF Valley	Typical July*
Total rainfall	4.1 mm	4.8 mm (driest July on record)	~57.7 mm
Average highs	—	21.1 °C	18.8 °C
Average lows	—	14.5 °C (warmest July on record)	12.9 °C
Hottest day	32.2 °C (11 July)	—	—

* Based on 1991–2020 Met Office climate averages for RAF Valley.

July 2026 set two records at RAF Valley in ninety-six years of observations: it was the driest July, and it had the warmest nights.

Rainfall reached just 4.8 mm — 8% of the July average of 57.7 mm — beating the previous driest July of 1935, which recorded 8.4 mm. The mean daily minimum temperature of 14.5 °C is the highest for any July in the record, and mean daily maxima of 21.1 °C rank sixth warmest. Sunshine totalled 269.3 hours, 142% of average and the eighth sunniest July on record.

Nights that never cool are the signature of a heatwave, and the local Bodorgan gauge recorded it directly. **The hottest day reached 32.2 °C on 11 July**, following 30.9 °C on the 10th. Ten days climbed to 25 °C or above and four exceeded 28 °C, including an unbroken five-day run from 8 July.

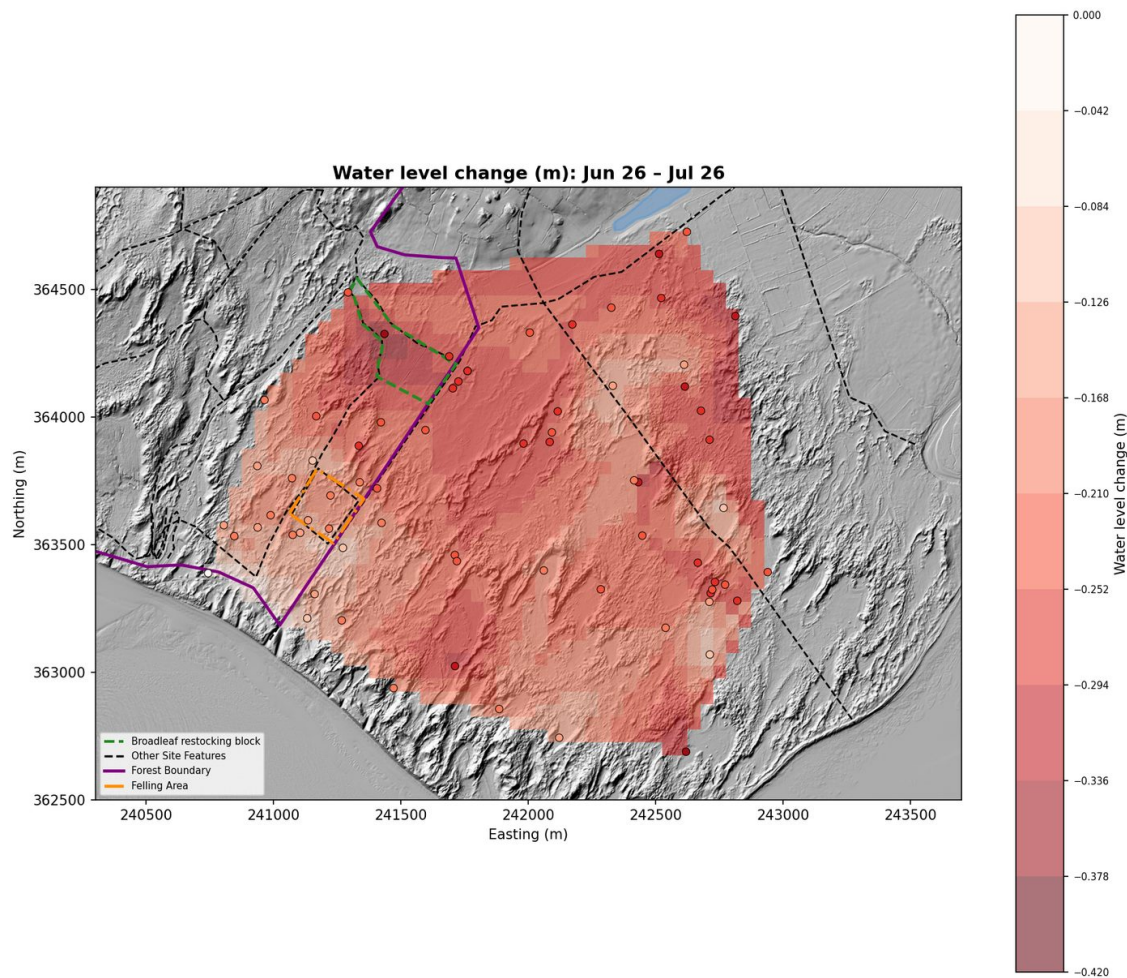
The heat fell inside the drought rather than beside it. Rain fell on only 2 of 31 days at Bodorgan, and the longest dry spell ran 22 days from 3 to 24 July — with the hottest stretch, the 8th to the 19th, sitting squarely within it. Sustained heat and high sunshine drive evaporation from the dune surface and transpiration from the vegetation, and with no rain arriving to offset either, the water table had nothing to draw on.

Despite the exceptional month, the hydrological year is not in deficit. Cumulative rainfall from October to July stands at **743 mm, or 104% of the average of 713 mm** — a wet winter left the dune system with a reserve going into summer.

Local Water Levels

The latest well round, on 3 August 2026, covered 71 monitoring dipwells across the reserve. Water levels are falling almost everywhere: **70 wells fell, none rose, and one was stable**. The mean change was **-0.22 m**.

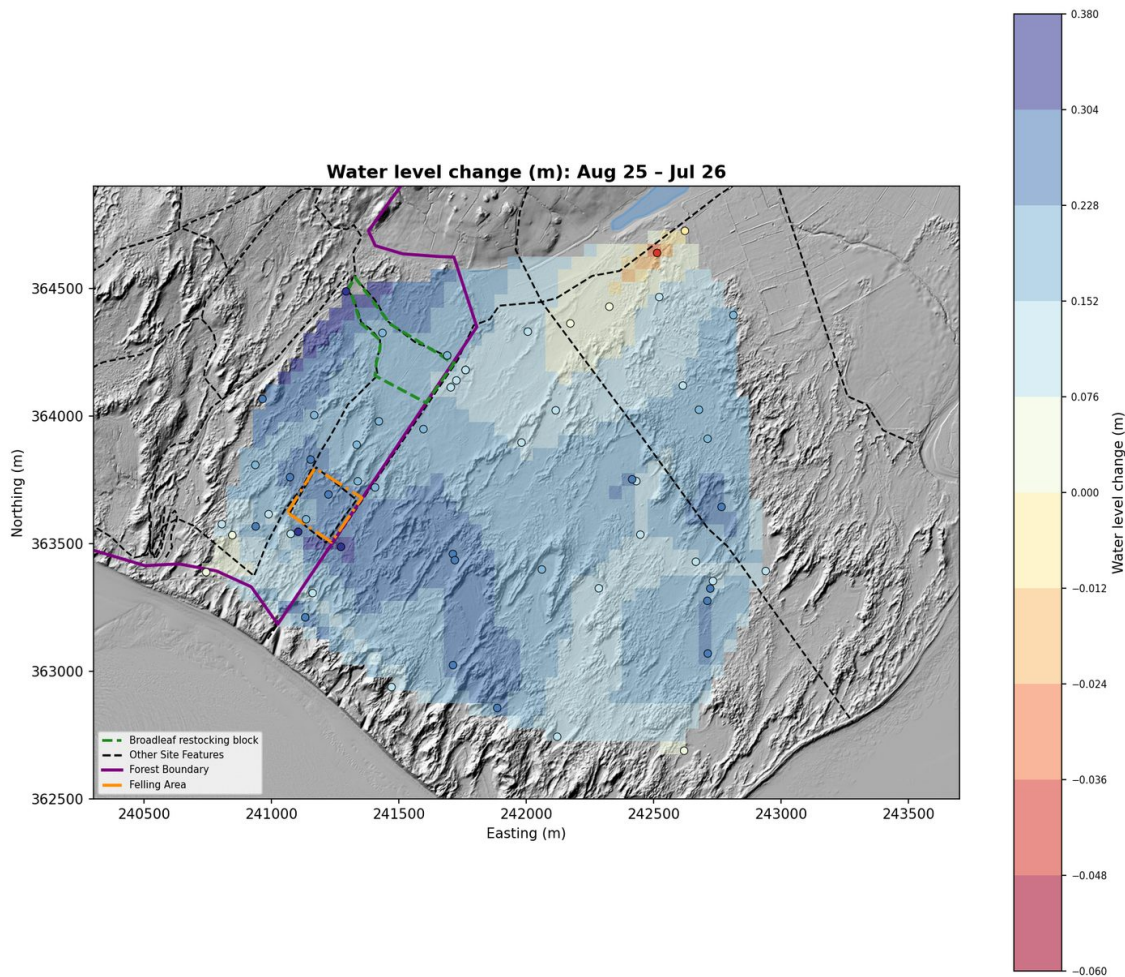
Month-on-month change: June 2026 to July 2026



Water level change (m) from June 2026 to July 2026. Blue = rising, red = falling.

The drawdown ranged from -0.37 m to -0.01 m. The largest falls were at nw10 (-0.37 m), ceh11 (-0.34 m) and L7 (-0.33 m); the smallest at ceh3 (-0.01 m), Nw8b and D38 (both -0.09 m).

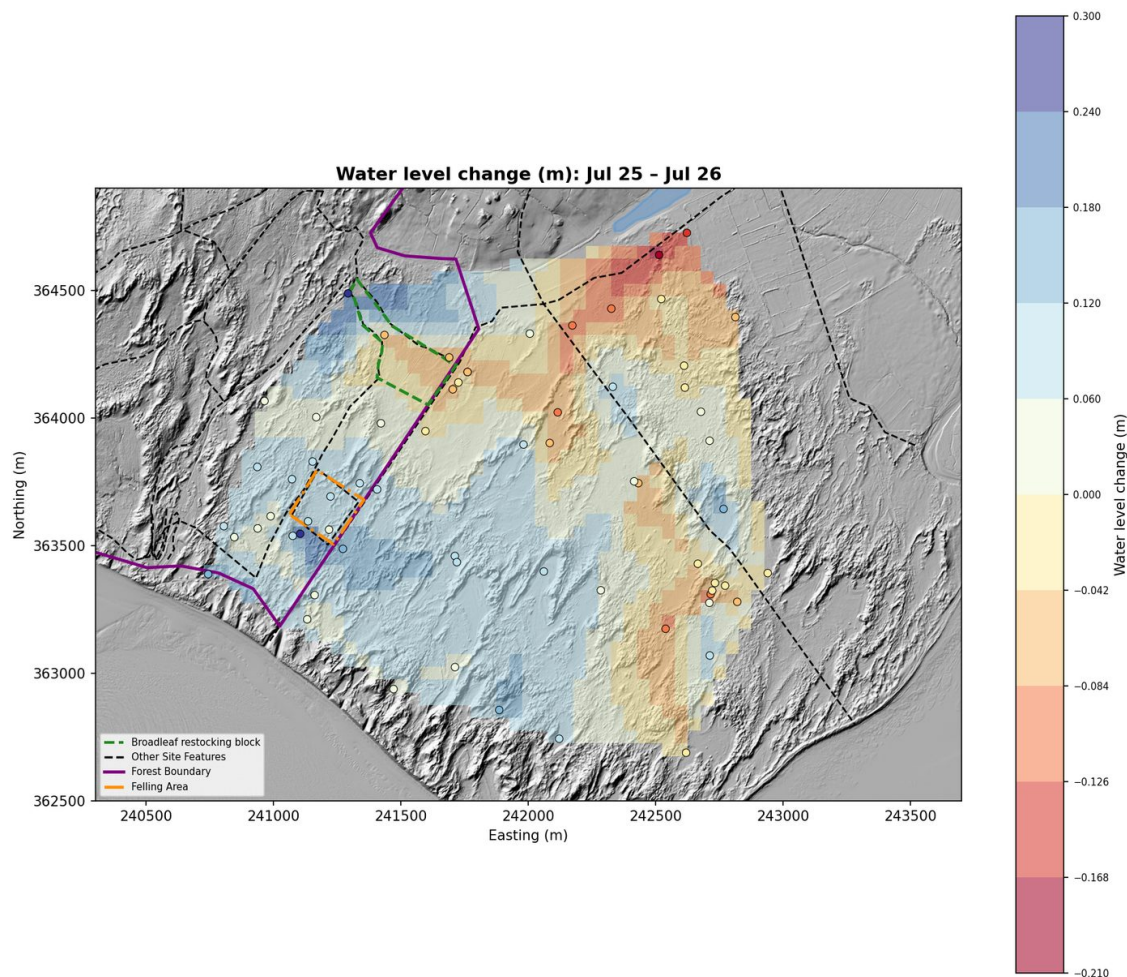
Rebound from the summer low: August 2025 to July 2026



Cumulative water level change since August 2025.

Measured against the summer low of August 2025, water levels remain **+0.17 m higher on average** across 60 wells, with a maximum rise of +0.36 m. Fifty-seven wells are still above their 2025 low point, one is below it, and two are unchanged. This is the reserve's winter recharge still working through the system, and it is what has cushioned the driest July on record.

Year-on-year comparison: July 2025 against July 2026



Year-on-year water level change from July 2025 to July 2026.

Compared with the same point last year, **37 of 68 wells are higher**, with a mean change of +0.03 m across a range of -0.19 m to +0.28 m. Year on year, the reserve is holding close to level.

Well Measurement Summary

Largest fallers and smallest changes, month on month

Smallest changes	Change (m)	Largest fallers	Change (m)
ceh3	-0.01	D10	-0.30
Nw8b	-0.09	nw5	-0.31
D38	-0.09	L7	-0.33
ceh20	-0.11	ceh11	-0.34
WMC1	-0.11	nw10	-0.37

Full data: 71 wells. Mean -0.22 m. Range -0.37 m to -0.01 m.

Newborough Warren groundwater monitoring. Water levels are measured monthly at dipwells across the dune system. A reading round driven at the end of a month, or in the first day or two of the next, records the level for the month just ended: the round of 3 August 2026 reports July 2026. Regional climate figures are from the Met Office station at RAF Valley; local rainfall is from the Bodorgan (IBODOR6) gauge.